

PREVIEW

THE
ETHIOPIAN
CODEX



The Books Your Bible Left Out

Explained Chapter by Chapter, With Every Source Cited

ENOCH · JUBILEES · MEQABYAN



CONTENTS



How to Read This Book	5
A Note on Sources	7
Why 81 Books?	8
PART I The Book of Enoch	17
PART II The Book of Jubilees	40
PART III Found Only in the Ethiopian Bible	51
PART IV Fact or Hype?	57
PART V Read It Yourself	70
A 30-Day Reading Plan	88
B Glossary	92
C Echoes in Your Bible	94
D Bibliography & Sources	96
About This Book	99



PART I

THE BOOK OF ENOCH

Watchers, Giants and the Man Who Walked With God



A short letter in the New Testament quotes a prophecy of "Enoch, the seventh from Adam."¹ The book those words closely match survives complete in only one language: Ge'ez.^{2,3}

1. King James Version [3]

2. Charles, 1 Enoch (1917) [1]; VanderKam 1996 [26]; Gentry & Fountain 2017 [27]

3. Britannica, "First Book of Enoch" [16]; Oesterley, intro. to 1 Enoch (1917) [12]; Nickelsburg 2007 [25]

The Scottish traveller James Bruce left Ethiopia and reached Marseille in March 1773.¹ According to the preface of Richard Laurence's translation, Bruce brought home three Ethiopic copies of Enoch: one for the library in Paris, one for his own collection, and one that went to the Bodleian Library in Oxford.¹

Laurence used the Bodleian copy. His English translation appeared in 1821, with a second edition in 1833.² Charles's later translation, used in this book, appeared in 1912 and in a shorter edition in 1917.³

THE WATCHERS DESCEND

The best-known story in 1 Enoch begins in chapter 6. It takes a few mysterious verses of Genesis and turns them into a drama.

Here is Genesis:

There were giants in the earth in those days; and also after that, when the sons of God came in unto the daughters of men, and they bare children to them, the same became mighty men which were of old, men of renown.



Genesis 6:4 · King James Version · public domain

That is all Genesis says. It does not call the "sons of God" angels, give them names, or mention a mountain.⁴

1. Laurence, preface (1883) [5]; Britannica, "James Bruce" [20]

2. Laurence, preface (1883) [5]

3. Charles, 1 Enoch (1917) [1]

4. King James Version [3]

Other Watchers, the text continues, taught enchantments and the cutting of roots, astrology, the constellations and the signs of the sun and moon.¹

In the story, this teaching is followed by disaster. The text says that "there arose much godlessness," and that people "became corrupt in all their ways."¹

THE GIANTS

The children of the Watchers are giants. The description is meant to shock:

“And they became pregnant, and they bare great giants, whose height was three thousand ells: Who consumed all the acquisitions of men.

 1 Enoch 7:2–3 · trans. R. H. Charles, 1917 · public domain

The giants consume everything people produce, then turn on humanity itself, and the earth "laid accusation against the lawless ones."¹

1 Enoch adds another detail. When the giants die, their spirits do not go to heaven. They stay on earth as evil spirits:

And now, the giants, who are produced from the spirits and flesh, shall be called evil spirits upon the earth, and on the earth shall be their dwelling.

 1 Enoch 15:8 · trans. R. H. Charles, 1917 · public domain

1. Charles, 1 Enoch (1917) [1]



“Enoch is quoted in the New Testament.”

SHORT ANSWER

Jude 14–15 quotes a prophecy it attributes to Enoch. It closely matches 1 Enoch 1:9.^{1,2}

WHAT THE SOURCES SAY

Jude writes: “Behold, the Lord cometh with ten thousands of his saints.”¹ 1 Enoch 1:9 reads: “And behold! He cometh with ten thousands of His holy ones.”²

In Greek, the two passages share about 72 percent of their words.³ Scholars differ on what that means: some see Jude treating Enoch’s words as genuine prophecy; others think Jude may be adapting a shared tradition, without making the whole book Scripture.⁴

WHERE THIS IDEA COMES FROM

This one is easy to check, which is why it spreads — and here, the viral claim is right.

1. King James Version [3]

2. Charles, 1 Enoch (1917) [1]; VanderKam 1996 [26]; Gentry & Fountain 2017 [27]

3. Gentry & Fountain 2017 [27]

4. VanderKam 1996 [26]; Gentry & Fountain 2017 [27]



“A council in 363 AD removed these books.”

SHORT ANSWER

The Synod of Laodicea did not mention Enoch or Jubilees, and its date is uncertain.¹

WHAT THE SOURCES SAY

Laodicea was a regional synod of bishops from Asia Minor.¹ Historians date it anywhere between 343 and 381; 363 is only one guess.¹

Its Canon 59 forbids reading “uncanonical books” aloud in church.¹ Its Canon 60 gives a list of books, but scholars have long doubted that canon is genuine.¹

Neither canon names Enoch, Jubilees, or any book being removed.¹ The claim that this council “removed” them is contradicted by the text of its own canons.

WHERE THIS IDEA COMES FROM

The date 363 is often attached to Laodicea in popular timelines, and from there the story of a “removal” gets attached to Enoch.

1. Synod of Laodicea, canons (NPNF) [6]